

## Proposal Project Report Components Final Due M 8/8 11:59 pm

<https://screencast-o-matic.com/watch/crjnIYViSUg>

Proposal readers are investors. You will be asking decision-makers to invest some resource, time or money, so your proposal of solving a problem or marketing a service or product can be done. You must then consider audience (who do you need to be directing this proposal to who can do something about this situation) and then decide the best resources and approach to persuade them. The following are required components of the proposal report itself. You represent a company or organization that is pitching an idea.

Here are some additional ideas for proposals:

- Imagine that a company has a problem or wants to make some sort of improvement. The company sends out a request for proposals; you receive one and respond with a proposal. You offer to come in, investigate, interview, make recommendations—and present it all in the form of a report.
- An organization wants a seminar in your expertise. You write a proposal to give the seminar—included in the package deal is a guide/handbook that people attending the seminar will receive.
- An agency has just started using a new online data system, but the user's manual is technically complex and difficult to read. You receive a request for proposals from this agency to write a simplified guide or startup guide.
- Imagine that a nonprofit organization focused on a particular issue wants an consultant to write a handbook or guide for its membership. This document will present information on the issue in a way that the members can understand.

Source: <https://coccoer.pressbooks.com/chapter/proposals/>

There is no specific length for this proposal. Each proposal is unique because it addresses a unique problem/issue and a unique audience. It should be thorough and comprehensive with research to defend content to make it a convincing document that your audience will accept your proposal.

Format is standard 1-inch margin, 12 size Times New Roman font double spaced with page numbers

**Here are some examples/resources:** (these are supplemental examples and explanations meant to give you ideas and suggestions but for our project please follow the descriptions/details I outlined below)

<https://venngage.com/blog/business-proposal/>

<https://www.instructionalsolutions.com/blog/proposal-examples>

<https://www.process.st/project-proposal/>

[http://woodbuffalo.albertacf.com/sites/default/files/woodbuffalo.albertacf.com/how\\_to\\_write\\_business\\_proposals.pdf](http://woodbuffalo.albertacf.com/sites/default/files/woodbuffalo.albertacf.com/how_to_write_business_proposals.pdf)

<https://coccoer.pressbooks.com/chapter/proposals/>

[https://www.tu-chemnitz.de/phil/english/sections/linguist/independent/kursmaterialien/TechCom/achtml/doc\\_proposal.html](https://www.tu-chemnitz.de/phil/english/sections/linguist/independent/kursmaterialien/TechCom/achtml/doc_proposal.html)

<https://pressbooks.bccampus.ca/technicalwriting/chapter/proposals/>

## Front Matter

**Title Page** (name of organization, project name, submitted to: who are you trying to persuade – audience, submitted from: company – your name, date, any graphics, company logo, slogan)

**Table of Contents** (sections, page numbers)

**Abstract** (a 4-5 sentence summary of project and need for project, on a separate page after the table of contents)

## Introduction

Introduce your proposal by:

- **Establishing the current situation** (describe what is happening right now in the area)
- **Defining the problem** (explain why it is a problem or why there is a need for product or service)
- **Providing evidence to substantiate problem** (give further reasons to show it is a problem/need)
- **Providing relevant background** (You must determine the quality and level of explanation of each of these four factors based on the audience and their prior familiarity, experience, and knowledge of the situation)

These four factors can and should be achieved by a mixture of text and visuals (charts, graphs, pictures, research, stats)

Once you have introduced the audience to the situation, give them your solution or new idea/service (what you plan to do about it).

## Plan

- **Define proposed plan** (best solution or product/service that would work and why and other solutions that would not work as well and why – counter any objections the audience may have to your proposal)
- **Present objective of the plan** (bottom line-explain what you are trying to achieve with your solution/product/service The Details, The Nuts and Bolts of the plan)
- **Discuss plan in relation to established criteria, standards, or specifications** (how does your proposal measure up to commonly held industry standards)
- **Electronic/Digital Component** infomercial, website, video, app, etc. Explain how you would promote your proposal concept through a digital feature. What digital feature? Why this feature-why is it best way to highlight your proposal? How will you develop it and promote it? etc. You do not have to actually create/produce electronic/digital component-you only have to explain what you would do.

## Benefits

**Explain probable benefits accruing from plan** REMEMBER-This proposal is a persuasion document – You want to overwhelmingly convince the investors that your proposal should be tried. Consider how you can best explain to the investors that your proposal will work and is the best- text, visuals?)

## Approach

- **Schedule:** Identify timeframe the company has for implementing the solution or production of service or product and the stages or benchmarks along the way
- **Costs/Budget:** Since you are trying to convince the investors of the validity of your proposal, you need to show them the costs/budget involved, how, why, where the money is being spent and projected profits they can expect Direct/indirect costs, personnel, materials, supplies, overhead, support staff
- **Management:** Experience with other organizations or people of similar size and scope, recommendations from other association executives Visual: A possible flowchart of company showing division of staff

## Evaluation

**Assess progress in meeting plan objective:** How will you gauge the success of the proposal Such as by six months, there should be this much \$ of profit or this aspect of the problem should be solved. How will you assess it, by dollars, satisfied customers' comments, surveys.etc.? How will progress be monitored and success be determined?

## Qualifications

**Consider capabilities of personnel and appropriateness of organization's experience, facilities, resources:** This is where you want to include a brief (paragraph) description, credentials, qualifications, or any special comments to convince the audience. Other features that lend credibility and authority to your narrative could include longevity/ turnover of staff, equipment.

## End Matter

- **Appendix:** supporting information useful to readers that would interrupt the flow of the body of the proposal's persuasive argument
- **Sources:** cited and used to gather research and information (works cited page)

Visuals, graphs, charts, excel sheets where appropriate should be components to the proposal  
<http://www.kn.pacbell.com/wired/grants>